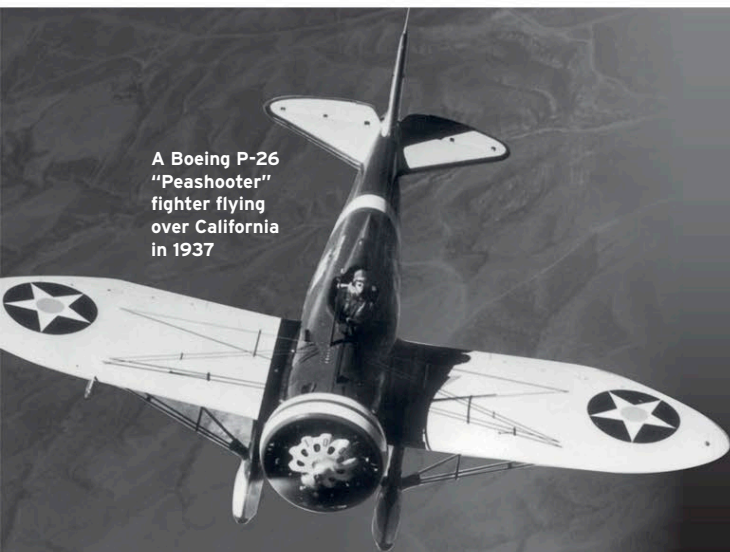


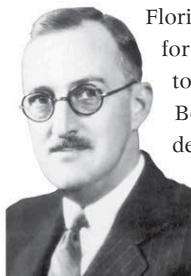


A Boeing P-26
"Peashooter"
fighter flying
over California
in 1937

Great Manufacturers Boeing

Boeing's aircraft dominate the history of aviation. Its bombers ended World War II and patrolled the skies during the Cold War, while its airliners revolutionized air travel. It produced the first modern airliner, the first successful jetliner, and the first wide-bodied "jumbo," so Boeing is important to airline chiefs.

THE SON OF A WEALTHY German mining engineer, William E. Boeing was born Wilhelm Böing in Michigan in 1881. After leaving Yale University, he initially worked in the Seattle timber industry, which would help him in an era when aircraft were made of wood and fabric. Taught to fly by US aviation pioneer Glenn L. Martin, Boeing bought and crashed one of Martin's seaplanes. While waiting for replacement parts, he realized it would be quicker to design and build his own aircraft. With the assistance of a friend, Commander G. C. Westervelt, their first machine—the B&W seaplane—flew in 1916, and in 1917 the Boeing Airplane Company was incorporated.



William E. Boeing
(1881-1956)

When the US entered World War I, Boeing sent two Model C seaplanes to the US Navy station at Pensacola, Florida. The navy placed an order for 50, and the company moved to larger premises, known as Boeing Plant 1. In 1923, it designed a fighter for the United States Army Air Corps (USAAC), the Boeing P-12/F4B. The success of the F4B led to the P-26, also known as the "Peashooter" because of its light armament.

This was the first all-metal American fighter, and the first monoplane to be operated by the USAAC. Boeing also built mailplanes, and in 1927, Boeing Air Transport won a major contract to deliver mail between San Francisco and Chicago, operating the Model 40A. As the company continued to expand, it produced more sophisticated aircraft, such as the metal Monomail. This was followed by the first modern airliner, the 247. By this time, Boeing also owned United Air Lines, but the Air Mail Act of 1934, prohibiting aircraft manufacturers and airlines from being part of the same corporation, split the company. William Boeing resigned and Clairmont Egtvedt took over as chairman.

Boeing went on to produce many successful airliners, including the famous 314 "Clipper" flying boats and the pressurized 307 Stratoliner, which used the wings and tail from the B-17. The 314s were the largest aircraft of the time, and Pan Am used them to set up both trans-Pacific and trans-Atlantic services. During World War II, Boeing built thousands of

"[People] will someday regard **airplane travel** to be as commonplace ... as train travel."

WILLIAM E. BOEING, 1929

Lounge area

The upper deck of the Boeing 747 was designed like a private members' club, where passengers could relax and enjoy a drink in style.



Traveling in comfort

A poster from the 1950s advertises the Boeing 707, the first successful jet airliner, flown by Pan Am from 1958. Its successor, the 720, was launched a year later.

